

Chapter

Show Love in Action — Loving the Right Way



Introduction: Beyond Mere Words

As Valentine's Day arrives, there is a flood of "I love you" messages and cards. But is love complete with that alone? In this short excerpt from a discourse, Acharya Upendra Ji gives a simple, practical principle of love: **love has to be shown not only in the heart and in speech, but in kriti — that is, in action.**

Saraswati — the goddess of knowledge, learning and speech. Here Acharya Ji uses the word "Saraswati" to mean the power of understanding, thought and speech.

Saraswati Until You Love, Not After

Understanding and discernment are needed before one loves. But if, after love has happened, you keep weighing and testing everything, that same intellect becomes the cause of a fall:

"So Saraswati is needed up to the point of loving. After love has happened, if Saraswati keeps being used, then it will lead to downfall."

Acharya Ji makes clear that this does not mean giving up knowledge — the problem lies in its **excessive** use:

"This does not mean that you are not to take a new update, not to take new knowledge. If you overuse it, that is where the problem will arise."

"Understand everything once — what love is, whom you were to love — and love has happened."

"I Love You, but I Won't Make Tea"

Once love has happened, it has to be lived. Acharya Ji explains with an everyday example from husband and wife that a claim of love without service is hollow:

"In love, you have to bring gifts. Now, which gift to bring — all that new learning — all that is fine. **But you have to bring a gift.** Is all this needed or not?"

"'I love you, but I won't make you tea.' He too says, 'I'll do everything, but I won't do all the housework.' **So is this love?**"

Not Speech, but Action

This is the central principle of the discourse. Having love in the heart and saying it in words — both are incomplete until it comes into action:

"Love has to be expressed — not only in heart, not only in words."

"That is Saraswati's work — 'I love you', bringing all these messages and cards — that is the speech part, that's done. **Show it in action.**"

The Example of Shri Krishna: Giving According to Your Capacity

Acharya Ji points to Shri Krishna as the ideal of showing love in action:

"Shri Krishna gave Radha so many things as gifts. **He would create an entire forest for her.** However much he made for her — giving grand, divine gifts."

"'My position is that of Dwarkadhish, so **I give you gifts according to that.**'"

This does not mean that only big gifts are love. The principle is to give **according to one's own capacity**:

"So they say, **even a poor man should give at least that much according to his means** — sometimes a ring, something. It should be expressed in that. Only in speech it is nice."

Offering Only a Shoulder Is Not Enough

Giving emotional support is good, but love does not end there:

"Then you are not to offer only this much — a shoulder. **Along with it, you actually have to give something,** now and then you will have to give a dress."

And this applies just as much to one's own wife. Becoming careless with the thought "she is my own anyway" is not love:

"Even if she is your own wife — I mean, I'm not talking about giving to someone else. 'She will go and get her own things' — not like that."

"'What, she's my wife, isn't she — I gave the money, you go, get it yourself' — **not that. Sometimes you have to visit** — I mean, wherever it is necessary, you should go."

Merely handing over money is not love; going together, giving time — this is love in action.

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1 Saraswati is needed up to the point of loving — use understanding and discernment to decide what love is and whom to love.
- 2 Even after love has happened, **excessive** use of the intellect leads to **downfall** — but you are not to stop taking new knowledge.
- 3 A claim of love without service is hollow — "I love you, but I won't make tea" is not love.
- 4 Love has to be expressed — **not only in heart, not only in words**. Messages and cards are the work of speech; **show love in action**.

- 5 Like Shri Krishna, give **according to your capacity** — if Dwarkadhish gives grand gifts, even a poor man should sometimes give a ring, something.
- 6 Offering only a shoulder (emotional support) is not enough — **now and then you also have to give something.**
- 7 Do not neglect your own wife thinking "she is my own" — **handing over money is not enough; sometimes you have to visit** — go together, give time.